Reusable Team Workflows with OpenAI Codex Skills



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Overview

Same request. Two different answers.

MONDAY

Release 1.3

- Gift wrap, author filter
- **Bumped dev deps ← chore**
- **Updated README ← chore**
- Fixed $100 checkout

THURSDAY

What's new

New: gift-wrap option
New: author search
Fix: /orders ← breaking!
(no version number)

Chores listed on Monday. A breaking change hidden on Thursday.

Capture it once → **Codex finds it** → **Same format every time**

Your takeaway: turn a repeated team chore into a skill Codex reuses.

Anatomy of a skill

File	What it does
`.agents/skills/release-notes/`	One folder per skill, inside the repo
`SKILL.md`	name + description, then the steps ← required
`scripts/collect_changes.py`	Deterministic work: same input, same output
`references/format.md`	Detail Codex reads only when needed

User-wide skills: ~/.agents/skills/

How Codex picks a skill



Inside SKILL.md

```
---
name: release-notes
description: Release notes or a
  changelog for commits since a tag
---
1. Run scripts/collect_changes.py <tag>
2. Write release-notes/<version>.md
   using references/format.md
3. Do not edit any other file.
4. Reply with path + counts.
```

FRONTMATTER
when to use it

STEPS
what to do

GUARDRAILS
what not to do

Plain Markdown. No code needed to make a skill.

Demo

What we'll do in Priya's repo

1. **WITHOUT A SKILL**
   Ask for release notes and see the result
2. **ADD THE SKILL**
   Copy release-notes into .agents/skills
3. **BY NAME**
   Run $release-notes in a new thread
4. **BY DESCRIPTION**
   Ask in plain words; Codex picks it
5. **REVIEW**
   Check the file in the review panel

Summary

Capture a chore once, reuse it

The description decides when it loads

Scripts make the steps repeatable

Skills guide Codex. You still review

Your first skill

Which chore does your team repeat every single week?

That is your first skill.



Then share it in the repo so the whole team gets it.